

LUCKNOW | Fading Trumpet

It was a double blow for Chief Minister Mayawati. First, it was the failure of the BSP's social engineering project in other states where her new-found Brahmin card failed to lure upper castes. Then came the Allahabad High Court order reinstating 18,000 policemen recruited during Mulayam Singh Yadav's government. Mayawati had dismissed the constables claiming that the selection process was "scandalous" following an inquiry by ADG S.K. Mishra soon after her Government assumed power last year. About a dozen policemen had committed suicide after their services were terminated. They had undergone complete physical and arms training during Yadav's regime. The Mayawati Government has decided to go to



THE COURT ORDER IS A RAP ON MAYAWATI'S KNUCKLES the Supreme Court to get a stay on the orders of the high court. 'Behenji' is not one to give up so easily. *by Subhash Mishra*

Mail Order

Mandarins in the Prime Minister's Office are busy signing up for new e-mail accounts. This follows the PMO asking all officers not to use the popular Gmail for official communication after Chinese hackers reportedly broke into even encrypted internal communication.

PATNA |

Rodent Row

Months after he allowed Bihar social welfare department bureaucrats to serve "protein-rich rat meat in Bihar restaurants", Chief Minister Nitish Kumar has withdrawn the scheme after some groups among the community protested the rat-farming scheme, saying that they required a computer mouse rather than a rodent farm to move forward in life.

by Amitabh Srivastava

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